

MERIDIAN TECHNOLOGIES PVT. LTD.

Internal Policy Document

Acceptable Use Policy

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1. Scope

Assets Covered

This Acceptable Use Policy covers all company-issued IT assets including laptops, desktops, mobile phones, tablets, software, networks, and cloud accounts.

It also covers any personal devices that are explicitly authorised to connect to company networks or to handle company data under the Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) supplementary policy.

Applicability

The policy applies to all employees, contractors, interns, and any third parties granted access to company IT assets.

Use of company IT assets in any country is governed by this policy and any additional local regulations applicable at the location of use.

2. Issuance of Devices

Standard Allocation

Each confirmed employee is issued one primary laptop. Additional devices (secondary monitors, mobile phones, tablets) are issued based on role eligibility and require approval from the Reporting Manager.

The laptop model is determined by the role and the standard hardware catalogue maintained by IT. Specific configurations outside the catalogue require IT Head approval.

Ownership and Return

Devices remain the property of Meridian Technologies throughout the period of issue and must be returned on separation or role change.

Tampering with the IT asset tag, factory reset without IT involvement, or unauthorised transfer to another employee is strictly prohibited.

3. Acceptable Use of Devices

Primary Purpose

Company devices are issued primarily for business use. Limited and reasonable personal use is permitted provided it does not interfere with work or violate any policy.

Examples of acceptable personal use include occasional personal email, online banking, and short news reading during breaks.

Restrictions

Employees must not modify hardware configurations, remove asset tags, or share device credentials with anyone, including family members.

Installation of hardware (RAM, storage) by the employee is not permitted; any hardware upgrade must be routed through IT to preserve warranty and support arrangements.

4. Software Installation and Licensing

Approved Software

Only software from the IT-approved catalogue (accessible via the IT Service Desk portal) may be installed. Self-installation through the catalogue is permitted for whitelisted titles.

The catalogue is refreshed quarterly. Requests for inclusion of new software may be raised through the IT Service Desk for review.

Unapproved Software

Installation of any software outside the approved catalogue requires a Software Request Ticket and IT Security review. Pirated, cracked, or unlicensed software is strictly prohibited.

Use of personal cloud storage (Dropbox, Google Drive, OneDrive personal) for company data is prohibited. The approved enterprise OneDrive must be used.

License Compliance

License compliance is the responsibility of both the employee and IT. Annual audits are conducted to reconcile installed software against entitlement records.

5. Internet and Email

Internet Use

Internet access is provided for business purposes. Browsing of websites containing illegal content, adult material, gambling, or known phishing or malware sources is blocked and logged.

Bandwidth-intensive activities not related to work (large personal downloads, streaming during meetings) may be throttled and flagged for managerial review.

Email Use

Company email accounts must not be used to subscribe to personal services or to send chain mails. Auto-forwarding of company email to personal accounts is strictly prohibited.

Out-of-office responses must be set up before any planned leave so that internal and external stakeholders are informed of the absence and the point of contact.

6. Remote Access and VPN

VPN and MFA

Remote access to company systems requires connecting through the company VPN with multi-factor authentication. Split tunnelling and use of personal proxies is prohibited.

The MFA factor must be the company-issued authenticator app or hardware token. SMS-based MFA is permitted only as a temporary fallback.

Public Networks

Access from public Wi-Fi networks is permitted only after VPN connection is established. Public Wi-Fi without VPN is forbidden for all company work.

Use of personal mobile hotspots is preferred to public Wi-Fi when an alternative is needed; mobile hotspot data may be reimbursed under the Communication Allowance scheme for eligible roles.

7. Personal Use

Reasonable Use

Personal use is permitted only outside core working hours and only for non-resource-intensive activities. Streaming, gaming, torrents, and cryptocurrency mining are strictly prohibited.

Personal storage on the company device should be minimised; any personal data is at the employee's own risk and may be wiped during routine IT operations.

Family and Friends

Allowing family members or friends to use the company device for any purpose is not permitted. The credentials are personal to the employee and not transferable.

8. Returns and Damages

On Separation

On separation, all devices must be returned to the IT Service Desk within 3 working days of the last working day. Failure to return devices may result in deduction from final settlement at replacement cost.

Personal data must be backed up by the employee before the last working day; IT does not retain employee personal data after the device is reclaimed.

Damage and Loss

Accidental damage must be reported within 24 hours. The first instance is treated as a no-fault event; subsequent damages may attract a recovery fee per the IT asset schedule.

Loss or theft of a device must be reported to IT Security and to the nearest police station; an FIR copy is required to process the replacement.

9. Monitoring

Right to Monitor

All activity on company networks and devices is subject to monitoring and audit. Employees should have no expectation of privacy for activities conducted on company IT assets.

Monitoring is conducted in accordance with applicable law and is proportionate to the legitimate interests of the company.

Data Retention

Logs of activity, including web browsing, email metadata, and security events, are retained for a defined period as per the Data Security Policy.

10. Penalties

Disciplinary Action

Breach of this policy may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination, recovery of damages, and in cases of legal violation, referral to law enforcement.

The severity of the action will depend on the nature of the breach, intent, and prior history of similar incidents.

Restoration of Access

Where access has been suspended following a breach, restoration requires the explicit clearance of the IT Security Head and the HR Head.